



Let It Out

A private space to think it through, one page at a time.

There's no right way to fill this out, and no one else needs to see it. Write as much or as little as you need. Sometimes just getting it out of your head and onto paper is enough to feel a little clearer.

1 What's bothering you?

Start wherever feels easiest. What happened? What's been sitting with you?

2 How does that make you feel?

More than one of these can be true at once. Circle whatever fits, there's no wrong answer.

Angry

Sad

Frustrated

Anxious

Overwhelmed

Crying right now

Numb

Embarrassed

Relieved

Don't know

Other: _____



3 Separating fact from feeling

Our minds often blend what actually happened with the story we tell about it. Try separating the two.

Just the facts: what a security camera would have recorded, no interpretation:

The story I'm telling myself about what it means:

Is there another way to see this? What might someone else say about it?

4 Ease the immediate stress

Before you try to solve anything, it can help to settle your body first. Try one of these for a minute or two:

-  **Box breathing:** in for 4, hold for 4, out for 4, hold for 4. Repeat 4 times.
-  **5-4-3:** name 5 things you can see, 4 you can hear, 3 you can touch.
-  **Step away:** give yourself 2 minutes before responding to anyone.
-  **Hand on chest:** take three slow breaths, in through the nose, out through the mouth.

5 One small next step

You don't need the whole plan figured out, just the next right-sized step.

What's one small thing that would make this feel even slightly better today?

What's one action you can take in the next 24 hours?

Who, if anyone, might help you think this through?
